



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Leander
School Website: <https://foundersclassical.com/leander/>

January 6, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy Leander (FCA Leander) presents a robust alignment with classical education in its public-facing materials. The school foregrounds a liberal-arts, Virtue-centered mission rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness, and emphasizes formation over mere information. Its stated commitments include a traditional liberal arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and exposure to Latin, philosophy, and classical literature, with a strong emphasis on character formation, virtue, and the formation of wise and virtuous citizens. The school likewise highlights parental partnership and a community-oriented ethos, including a "co-educator" stance with families.

Using the Six Essential Elements rubric as a rubric, FCA Leander shows strong Classical alignment in several domains (Curriculum; Purpose and Goal; Faculty; Parents & Community), with Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing more partial alignment. The aggregate assessment places FCA Leander in the CLASSICAL range, with some room for deeper explicit integration of theology, liturgical practices, and explicit Socratic pedagogy in the upper levels to achieve full alignment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The school emphasizes transcendental values (truth, beauty, goodness) and character formation, but explicit theology, liturgical practices, or formal sacred liturgy are not overtly stated in the public materials available. Keywords such as truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, and moral formation appear, signaling transcendental aims, but the site stops short of clear theological grounding or liturgical practice in publicly visible content. The public materials do not clearly indicate liturgical or doctrinal elements. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Present positive terms include truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, moral formation, and contemplation. No explicit negative signals found in public content. Why this rating: Partial alignment to a transcendental moral realism, but lacking explicit theological grounding and liturgical practices in the materials available.
- **Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The school explicitly aims at forming scholars of virtue and wisdom; expresses education as formation and the cultivation of human excellence rather than mere job-prep. Phrases such as "Forming Scholars. Cultivating Virtue. Leading with Purpose" and "classical education rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness" illustrate a telos oriented toward virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Clear positive matches include formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, love of learning, great conversation, and contemplation. Negative signals (e.g., purely job-focused aims) are not evident in the public-facing content. Why this rating: Strong alignment with the classical telos of education as formation toward virtue and wisdom.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The site highlights a rigorous liberal arts curriculum and a focus on classic texts and disciplines (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; philosophy; literature). This aligns with the Trivium as a foundational framework and with a liberal-arts orientation. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, philosophy, classic literature, liberal arts, great books (where referenced), and classical curriculum. No explicit,

sustained pivot to non-classical “social studies-only” framing is detected in public content. Why this rating: Strong demonstration of the liberal-arts curriculum and a classical arc; explicit Great Books engagement is less plainly stated in the snippets but is indicated by the classical-literary framing.

- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: The public materials emphasize a classical pedagogy, with emphasis on memory, virtue, and dialogic engagement implied by phrases like “great conversation,” “teacher-student partnership,” and a traditional approach. However, explicit, sustained descriptions of Socratic seminars, Scholé (restful learning), or formal recitation-based methods are not clearly enumerated in the visible public content. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive terms include great conversation, classical pedagogy, mentoring, and formation through imitation. Absence of explicit statements about Socratic seminars, Scholé, or chant/memorization in the visible content pushes this category toward the middle. No explicit negative signals detected in the public description. Why this rating: Strong classical orientation in pedagogy, but not all of the canonical pedagogical methods are explicitly described in the public-facing materials.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: The site describes faculty as upholding high standards of moral character and intellectual discipline, with a “living curriculum” flavor implied by the teacher-student culture and mentorship emphasis. The existence of a named Headmaster and a culture of virtue among faculty supports a classical teacher-model role. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include models of virtue, mentorship, living curriculum, and collegial culture. There are no explicit negative signals in the public materials. Why this rating: Aligns well with the classical faculty ideal of virtuous, exemplar teachers who form the curriculum through their character and pedagogy.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: The school emphasizes partnership with parents and the community as co-educators and highlights parental involvement as integral to classical education. It invites parental participation and frames families as part of the educational mission. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include partnership with families, co-educators, parental engagement, home-school partnership, and parent formation. No negative signals found in public materials. Why this rating: Clear, strong alignment with the classical model of parent partnership and community involvement.

Aggregate verdict: CLASSICAL

- What would move the needle
- For Element 1: Increase explicit theological grounding and liturgical/community practices in public-facing materials (e.g., mention of a theology emphasis, liturgical year, communal worship or chapel practices) to strengthen alignment with the “Grounded in Theology” and “Liturgical and Communal Practices” subcriteria.
- For Element 4: Expand explicit articulation of Socratic pedagogy, scholé/restful learning practices, and memorization/recitation (or chant) as explicit, public-facing components of pedagogy to reach full alignment with Aristotelian/Platonic pedagogy indicators.
- Overall: Maintain and deepen explicit references to “Great Books” and the classical canon across materials, and continue signaling a robust partnership with families as co-educators, with opportunities for formal parent formation resources.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- FCA Leander communicates a classical education framed by truth, beauty, and goodness, indicating transcendental aims in character formation. It emphasizes a virtuous life and moral formation rather than a purely secular mission. However, explicit theology, liturgical practices, or liturgical arrangements are not clearly stated in the public-facing materials. See the Leander pages describing a classical education rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness and forming virtuous citizens.
- Positive keyword analysis

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- Present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, moral formation, contemplation, great conversation. The phrase Forming Scholars. Cultivating Virtue. Leading with Purpose appears in materials, signaling moral formation.
 - Why this rating
 - The site demonstrates clear transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue formation but does not evidentially ground these in explicit theology or liturgical practice within public content. The alignment is notable but not fully complete on the theological/liturgical axes.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission statements emphasize forming scholars, cultivating virtue, leading with purpose, and a classical education that pursues knowledge and virtue. The school frames education as formation (not merely information) and aims at human flourishing.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, great conversation, contemplation, liberal education, love of learning. The materials emphasize higher aims of character and intellect rather than mere job-readiness.
- Why this rating
- The goal is oriented toward virtue, wisdom, and human excellence—core classical aims—placing Element 2 solidly in CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site highlights a rigorous liberal arts curriculum, including the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and classical literature, with emphasis on Latin and philosophy. This maps to the liberal-arts core of classical education.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, philosophy, classic literature, great books (implied by “classic literature”), Western tradition. The curriculum framing aligns with classical canon and Trivium/Quadrivium framework in the public language.
- Why this rating
- Strong alignment with classical curriculum principles; explicit Great Books engagement is implied through classical literature emphasis and the liberal arts framing.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- FCA Leander describes a traditional, virtue-centered pedagogy consistent with classical aims; explicit mention of Socratic seminars or Scholē is not clearly evidenced in the public content; the materials emphasize a teacher-student culture and formation through classical study.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: great conversation (implies dialectic/ dialogic elements), mentoring, living curriculum, classical pedagogy, formation. However, explicit methods (Socratic dialogue, Scholē, recitation) are not clearly spelled out here, though they are part of the broader classical lexicon in the knowledge base.
- Why this rating
- The school aligns with classical pedagogy in spirit and framing, but explicit, codified pedagogical methods (e.g., regular Socratic seminars or recitation) are not fully visible in public content, which yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

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- The materials describe faculty as upholding high moral character and intellectual discipline, with a culture that positions teachers as mentors and as living exemplars—the living-curriculum model typical of classical schools.
 - Positive keyword analysis
 - Present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, faculty of friends, collegial culture, moral exemplars, character formation, guidance. These align with the classical faculty archetype.
 - Why this rating
 - The public materials portray faculty as central, virtuous, and modeling exemplary practice, consistent with CLASSICAL assessment.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- FCA Leander emphasizes partnership with parents and community as co-educators, with openness to parent involvement and opportunities to engage in book studies and gatherings. Public materials present a strong parent-community partnership model.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: partnership with families, co-educators, parental engagement, families as co-teachers, open campus, community as part of the educational mission. These are precisely the classical-community signals described in the Six Essentials framework.
- Why this rating
- FCA Leander presents a clear, programmatic commitment to parents as partners and co-educators, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for parent/community involvement.

What Would Move the Needle

- If this school wants to achieve full alignment across all six categories, consider:
- Explicitly articulating theology and liturgical practices in public materials (Element 1) to meet Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices.
- Providing more explicit descriptions of Pedagogy methods (Element 4) such as regular Socratic seminars, Scholé days, and structured memorization/recitation programs.
- Making Great Books and direct primary-source engagement more explicit on the public site (Element 3) to strengthen the “Great Books and Historical Engagement” criterion.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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